Spark Sport

NZNOG

31 January 2019

Campbell Fraser

Outline

- Spark Sport Update
- Timeline
- Technology Update
- Trial Options
- Moving to BAU

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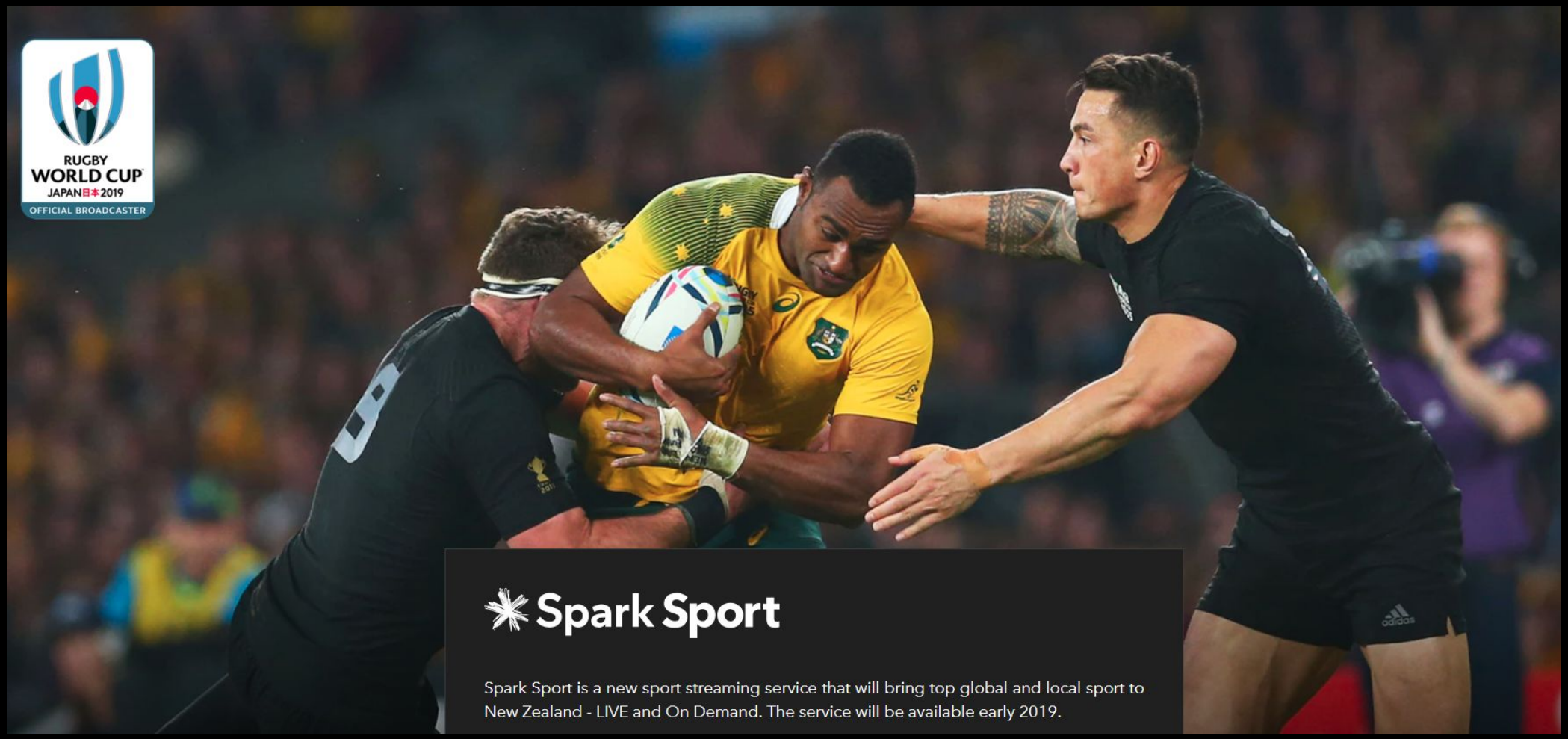
RUGBY
WORLD CUP
JAPAN日本2019
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Spark Sport
Spark Sport is a new sport streaming service that will bring top global and local sport to New Zealand - LIVE and On Demand. The service will be available early 2019.

Content Announced To Date

Rugby

- Rugby World Cup 2019
- Women’s Rugby World Cup 2021
- World Rugby U20 Championships 2019
- Heineken Champions Cup

Football

- Premier League
- Manchester United TV
- Liverpool TV

Basketball

- NBA TV

Motorsport

- Formula One World Championships
- Formula 2 Championship
- GP3 Series
- 2019 Porsche Super Cup Series
- World Rally Championship

Hockey

- Hockey World Cup
- Hockey Pro League
- Olympic Qualification
- National Hockey League

Retail Product

From Launch

- Web browser
- Apple iPhones and iPads
- Android phones and tablets
- Google Chromecast

Roadmap

- Selected Samsung TVs
- Apple TV
- Panasonic, LG and Sony Smart TVs etc

Pricing and packages not yet announced

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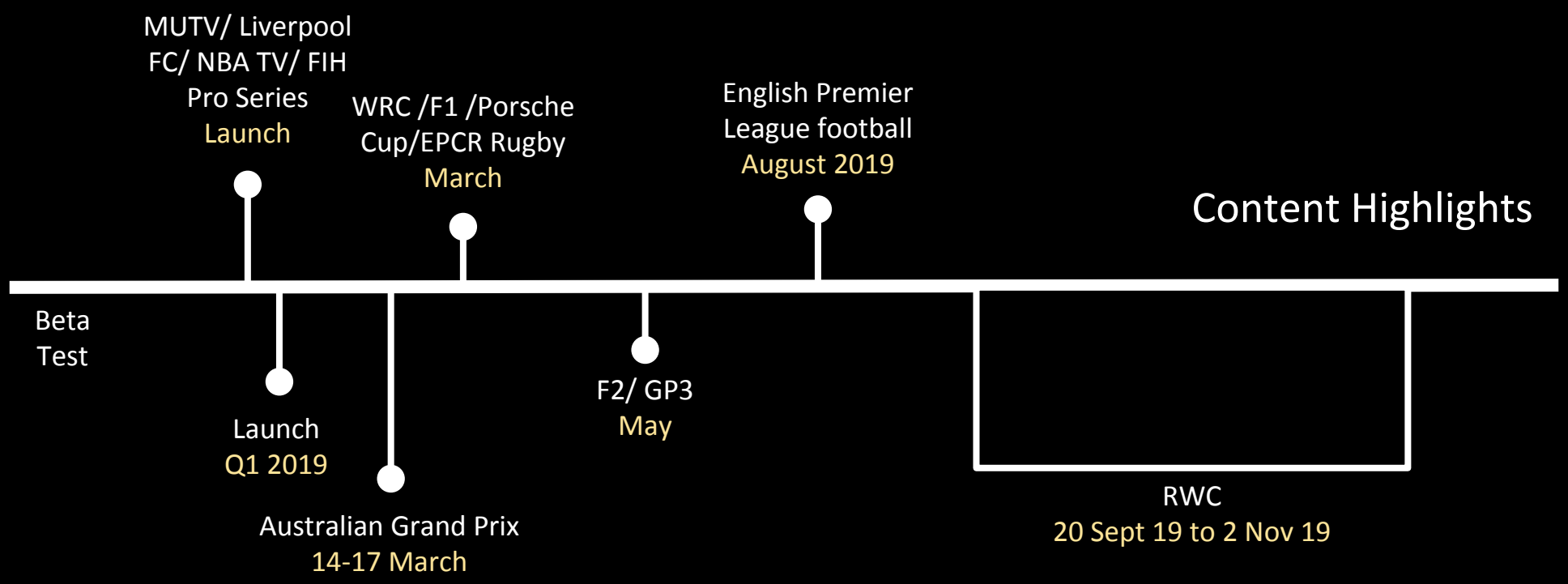
timeline.

timeline


MUTV/ Liverpool FC/ NBA TV/ FIH Pro Series
Launch
WRC /F1 /Porsche Cup/EPCR Rugby
March
English Premier League football
August 2019
Content Highlights
Beta Test
Launch
Q1 2019
Australian Grand Prix
14-17 March
F2/ GP3
May
RWC
20 Sept 19 to 2 Nov 19

technology.

Video renditions optimised for device and networking conditions (updated)

Profile	Target	Bitrate (Kbps)	Indicative Resolutions	Audio Bitrate (kbps)	Audio Codec
1	SD OTT Devices	250	320x180	96	AAC-LC, 2 ch.
2	SD OTT Devices	600	448x252	96	AAC-LC, 2 ch.
3	SD OTT Devices	950	576x324	96	AAC-LC, 2 ch.
4	SD OTT Devices	1500	768x432	96	AAC-LC, 2 ch.
5	SD OTT Devices	2250	960x540	96	AAC-LC, 2 ch.
6	HD OTT Devices	3500	1280x720	96/192	AAC-LC, 2 ch.
7	HD OTT Devices	6000	1920x1080	96/192	AAC-LC, 2 ch.

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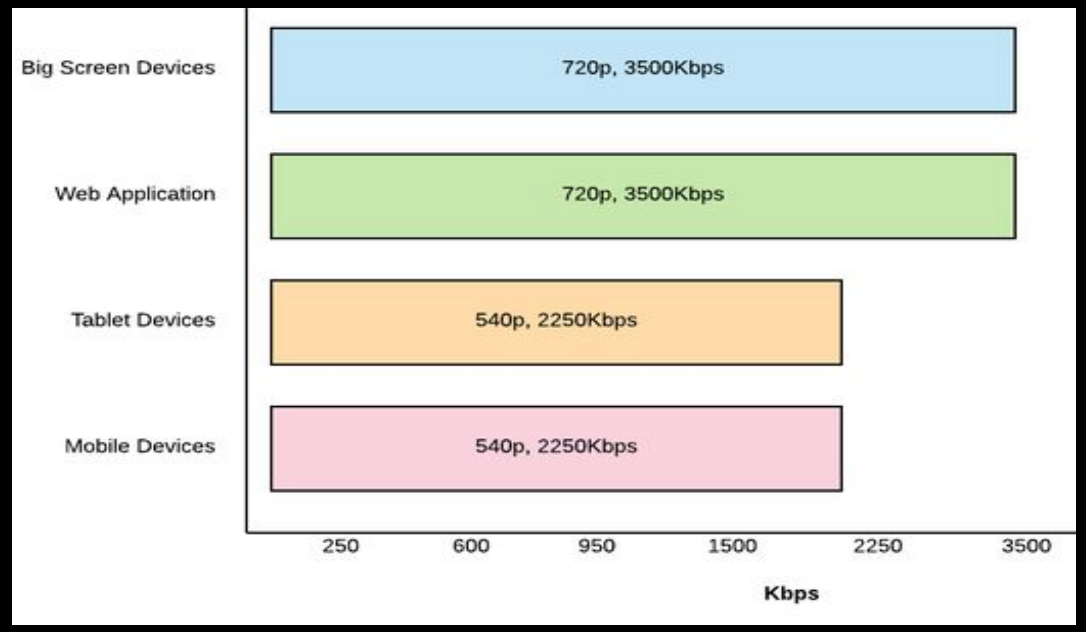
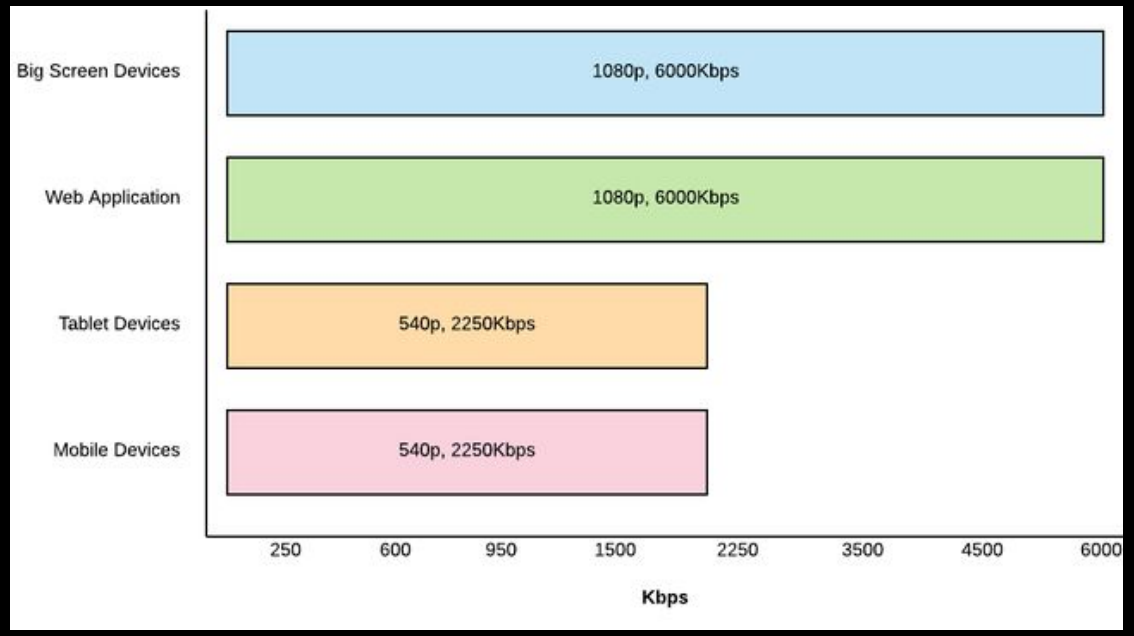
Video renditions device limits



Mobile and WBB



Fixed line renditions

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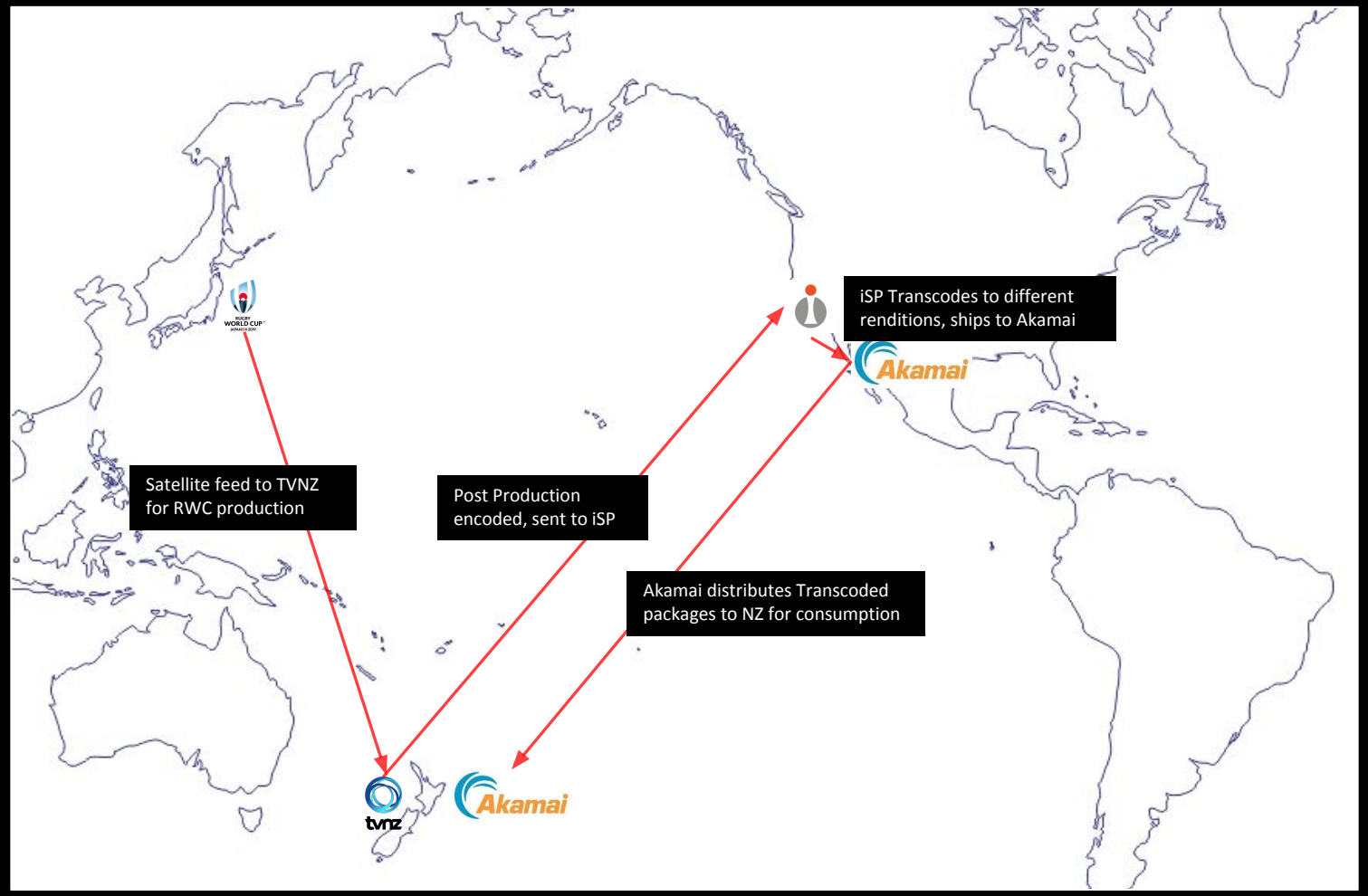
RWC High Level view



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RWC Distribution within NZ

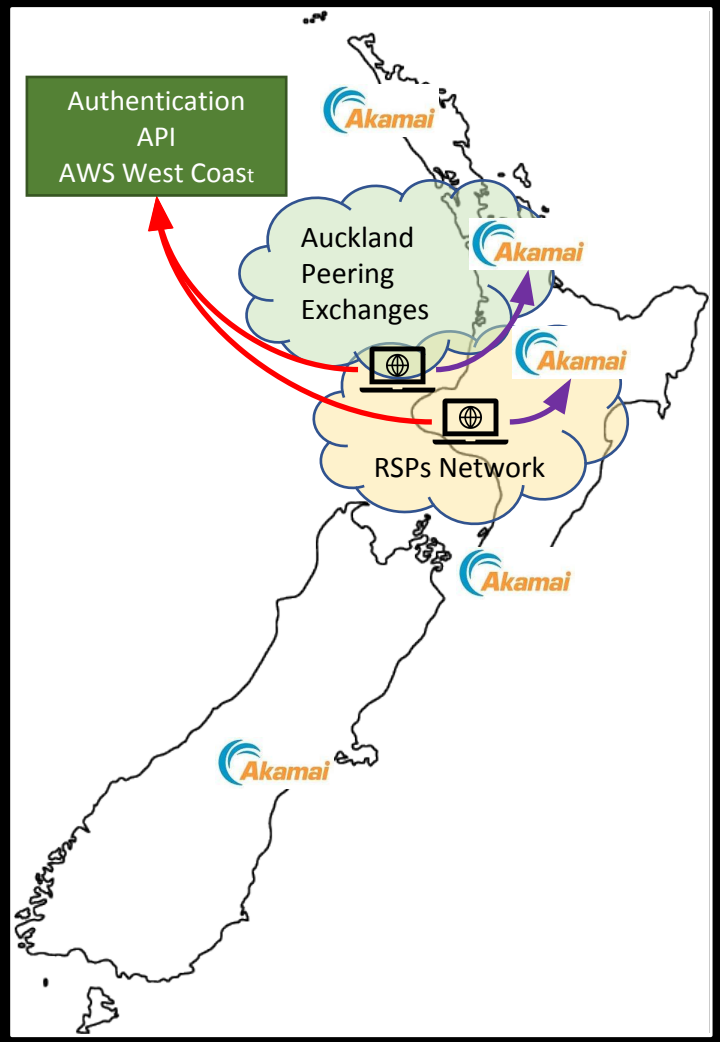
Akamai receives and distributes transcoded feeds from iSP to all its Live Stream nodes in NZ.

RWC will be using Akamai Media Services Live, these services protect origin from traffic flooding

User authentication delivered out of AWS West Coast

User streams from mapped Akamai Edge Node

- Either local to RSP or Auckland Peering Exchanges
- Bit rates 3.5 – 6 Mbps per user for HD
- Speak to your Akamai AM to ensure mapping is efficient to your network!
- Full Akamai architecture has not been finalized.



What we expect for launch

- Prime live content available WRC/F1/Porsche Cup/EPCR Rugby
- Various VOD content available
- We may see higher than expected usage levels:
  - Curious interest in the platform
  - Users testing pre RWC
- We are expecting 10% of RWC traffic as BAU

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Summary:

Spark Sport will appear like normal Akamai traffic to your network from launch!

Augmenting Akamai Infrastructure for RWC

- NZ Akamai network is to be scaled to support RWC peak throughput of 2.8 Tbps
  - This is based on a planning assumption of 500k concurrent users for RWC and the expected mix of devices/bit rates
  - Spark Sport is funding this upgrade of the Akamai infrastructure to support RWC. Akamai are determining where this capacity is needed across New Zealand operators.
  - Akamai has modelled throughput requirements on per operator level which they are happy to share on a bilateral basis
  - Contact at Akamai if needed: Dave Dickford

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Reach out to your Akamai contacts to understand what it means for your network!

testing.

Why Test ?

- Operators have told us they would like to test Spark Sport on their networks
- Impact of Spark Sport on your network is determined by two factors:
  a) How traffic from Akamai reaches your customers through your network
  b) The amount of extra traffic generated by Spark Sport customers
- Trial can help you understand traffic flows but we don't expect heavy loading of the service from day 1. Peak loading will be with RWC, starting Sept 2019
- The retail proposition and experience (including the interface etc) are out of scope for industry testing.

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Two options for testing

- **Beta trial ahead of launch (February 2019)**
  - Limited in size, scope and timeframe
  - Strict confidentiality and signed NDA
  - Limited opportunity to provide feedback
  - Max of one beta trial account per operator

- **Test with the live service from launch (March 2019)**
  - Production version with streaming content day 1
  - Public product - no confidentiality, NDA
  - Experience customer sign up journey
  - More opportunity to provide feedback and get support

- Contact Dave Simpson if you would like to participate in Beta Trial before 7 February: dave.simpson@spark.co.nz

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after launch.

Moving to BAU

- Customers with issues with the Spark Sport service/application should be referred to the Spark Sport helpdesk
- Network routing issues should be referred to Akamai and Spark Sport (or Wholesale/Upstream SP). Spark Sport may be able to help identify the issue and facilitate resolution
- NOC to NOC communication process available if needed

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next steps.

next steps

- Key messages from today:
  - The product will launch in Q1 2019 with a range of content
  - Now is the time to plan to be ready for RWC (September 2019)
  - All RSPs need to talk to Akamai and Chorus/LFCs to ensure they have sufficient capacity. The working assumption is an aggregate 2.8Tbps uplift at peak for RWC
  - As noted previously each RSP will need to make their own assessment of the traffic impact for their network. Akamai can help !
- Network Testing
  - Beta testing – email Dave Simpson dave.simpson@spark.co.nz by 7 Feb
  - Launch testing – just do it!
- Next NIWG session Pre-RWC (May/June)

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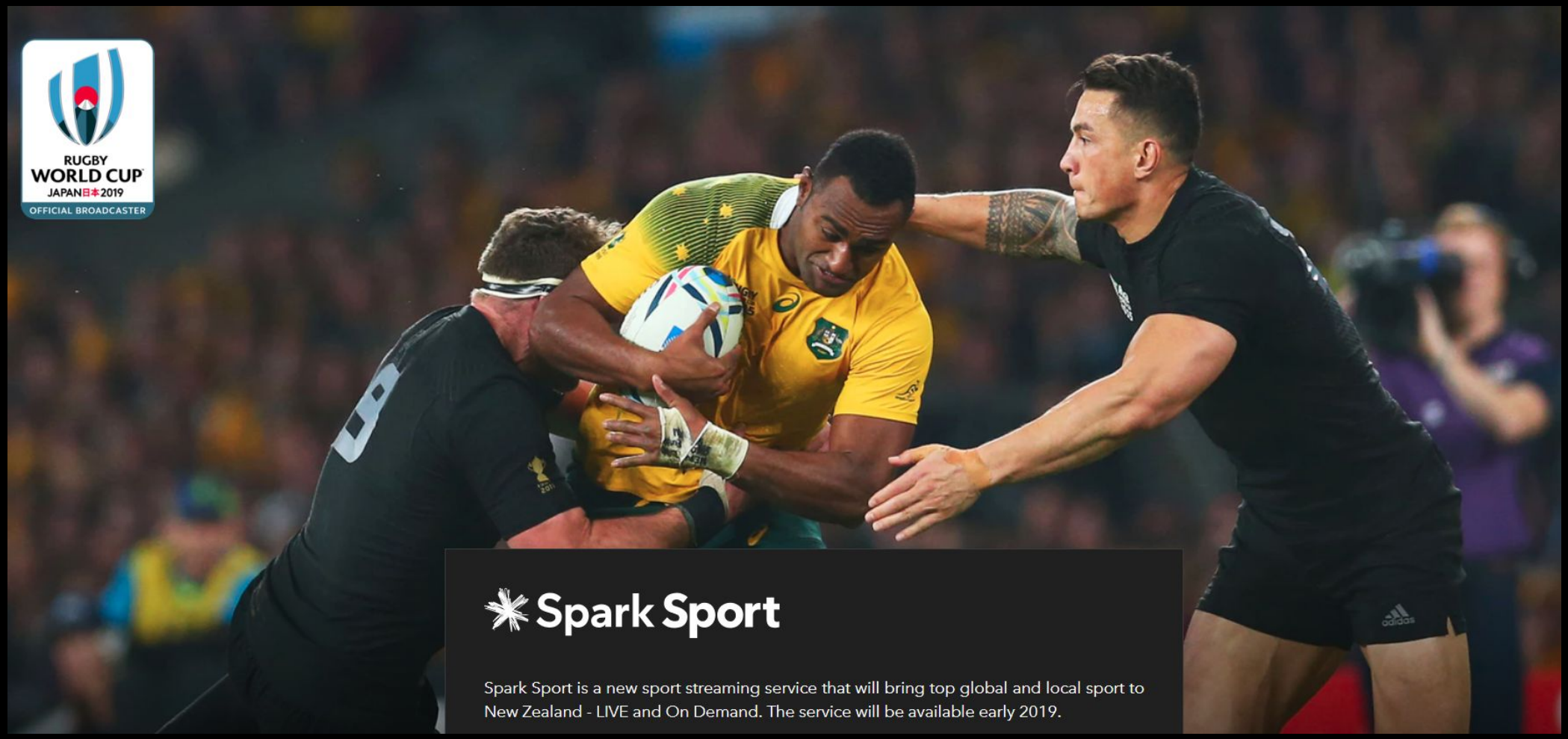
questions.

Industry Contact:

dave.simpson@spark.co.nz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